

LOGAN LARA

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EDUCATION

Western Governors University

May 2027

Bachelor of Science (BS), Computer Science

- Relevant Coursework: Software Engineering, Data Structures and Algorithms, Databases, Generative AI in Software Development

PROJECTS

Algorithmic Trading & Backtesting Platform | Python, FastAPI, PyTorch, scikit-learn, pandas, yfinance

Mar 2026 - Present

Independently designed and built production-grade trading system to apply CS fundamentals beyond coursework.

github.com/logan-the-engineer/logans-algorithmic-trading-platform

- Architected a layered monolith (HTTP -> service -> domain -> infra) in Python and FastAPI with strict unidirectional dependency flow, keeping simulation engine independently testable and strategies hot-swappable.
- Built a bar-by-bar backtesting engine that ingests live OHLCV data via yfinance, applies configurable fees and slippage in basis points, force-closes open positions at the final bar, and computes real performance metrics: total return, CAGR, Sharpe ratio, max drawdown, and win rate.
- Trained and deployed two ML strategies: a RandomForest classifier on gold futures (GC=F) and a Deep Q-Network reinforcement learning agent on SPY, defining state space as a 10-bar OHLCV lookback buffer, reward as per-bar P&L, and training the policy end-to-end with PyTorch. Each strategy owns its own feature pipeline and registers via a graceful-skip pattern for runtime resilience.
- Attributed RandomForest accuracy shortfall to market regime shift via feature/performance analysis.
- Achieved 36 passing tests across 7 files using pytest and a mock MarketDataPort, eliminating all network calls from the test suite and validating happy-path and error-path behavior end-to-end.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Jackson Financial Inc.

Feb 2025 - Mar 2026

Cybersecurity Analyst Associate (Security Operations Center)

- Performed infrastructure and endpoint security engineering tasks, including server decommissioning and post-migration tooling validation using Jira, Tanium, and Qualys to maintain security control coverage across the enterprise.
- Investigated and remediated potential threats by correlating login, firewall, and MFA log anomalies against maintenance windows using Azure, CrowdStrike, Splunk, and Palo Alto tools.
- Led weekend SOC shift as primary analyst, triaging and prioritizing detections, delegating investigations to other on-shift analysts, and conducting end-of-shift handoffs to ensure continuity.
- Analyzed 900+ phishing incidents using malware sandboxes and email header forensics, protecting \$600k+ in client assets from social engineering attacks.

DataAnnotation

May 2024 - Sep 2024

AI Trainer (Independent Contractor)

- Stress-tested 10+ large language models by designing adversarial prompts to evaluate accuracy, reasoning, safety, and verbosity, documenting systematic failure modes to inform fine-tuning and safety alignment workflows.
- Designed multi-turn adversarial conversations to systematically elicit hallucinations and reasoning failures in LLMs, escalating prompt complexity across turns to identify model limits and surface latent failure modes.

National Society of Black Engineers

May 2022 - Nov 2023

President

- Secured 97% chapter support for presidency and assembled the first fully-staffed executive board of 16+ members since 2019.
- Designed and deployed a two-tier task management system tracking priorities, assignments, deadlines, and progress across all board zones, replacing ad hoc coordination with structured operational workflows.
- Restructured board operations from single weekly all-hands meeting into biweekly all-board cadence for cross-zone updates and weekly zone meeting structure for zone-specific work, establishing documented meeting notes practice that drove chapter recognition, including Outstanding Professional Organization of the Year and 2nd Place for NSBE Region IV Chapter of the Year.

Lear Corporation

May 2023 - Aug 2023

Controls Engineer Intern

- Self-taught ladder logic in one week to support PLC test system development for automotive manufacturing.
- Resolved a critical false-pass bug in a car seat functionality PLC test through root cause analysis, preventing defective units from passing quality control undetected.
- Prepared technical reports and presented bug findings to engineers and management, prompting a company-wide code review of PLC test systems.

KPMG

Aug 2022 - Aug 2022

Finalist, Future of Tech Summit Case Competition

- Structured carbon-neutrality solution and led panel Q&A for a cross-functional team, with performance prompting KPMG recruiter to fast-track consideration for internship interview process; placed as finalist among 15 teams.

SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++

Frameworks & Libraries: HTML, CSS, FastAPI, Pydantic, pytest, pandas, numpy, scikit-learn, PyTorch

Tools & Concepts: REST API Design, Object-Oriented Design (OOD), Data Structures & Algorithms (DSA), Git, SQL, System Design, Cloud Infrastructure (Azure), Technical Documentation

AI/ML: Reinforcement Learning (DQN), Large Language Models (LLM Evaluation & Red-Teaming), Feature Engineering